

Does God Exist?

Influence, Information & the Battle for Minds

A National-Level Virtual Debate & Personality Development Programme

Organised by **NIT Jalandhar Student Initiative**

Date: 15 Feb

Mode: Google Meet

Programme Vision

In the modern era, power is no longer exercised only through weapons or borders—it is shaped through **information, narratives, perception, and psychological influence**. Social media has emerged as one of the most decisive tools in contemporary conflict, governance, and public opinion shaping.

This programme is designed to cultivate **clear thinking, structured expression, leadership presence, and ethical awareness** in young minds—skills that are indispensable for future leaders, professionals, and responsible citizens.

Who Should Participate

This programme is curated for: - Students aspiring to leadership roles in **administration, defence, policy, corporate, and public life** - Individuals seeking to improve **communication, confidence, and decision-making under scrutiny** - Students preparing for **group discussions, interviews, and high-pressure evaluations** - Young thinkers interested in **geopolitics, national security, media literacy, and strategic affairs**

(No eligibility barriers. Open to all motivated students.)

Core Objectives

- Develop **clarity of thought** and structured reasoning
 - Enhance **articulation, language control, and persuasive communication**
 - Build **confidence, initiative, and leadership presence**
 - Encourage ethical awareness and responsible digital behaviour
 - Train participants to think beyond surface-level narratives
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Debate Theme

Does God Exist?

An exploration of whether the universe's origin, order, and consciousness point to a divine cause or natural processes.

Indicative Debate Point Hints *(for guidance only)*

- Origin of the universe: divine creation versus the Big Bang theory
- Existence of fine-tuning in the universe and its possible interpretations
- Evolution as a biological process and its compatibility with belief in God
- Whether scientific laws require a law-giver or arise naturally
- Consciousness and human self-awareness beyond material explanations
- Limits of science in explaining the “first cause” of existence
- God as a philosophical necessity versus a faith-based belief
- Harmony or conflict between religion and modern science
- Moral values: divinely inspired or socially evolved
- Respect for all religions while questioning ideas, not beliefs

(Participants are encouraged to research, analyse, and present independent viewpoints.)

Evaluation & Marking Scheme

Participants will be assessed by a structured evaluation panel based on the following parameters:

- **Clarity of Thought & Relevance of Content** – 30 Marks
- **Communication Ability & Language Control** – 30 Marks

- **Initiative, Confidence & Leadership Presence** – 20 Marks
- **Behaviour & Social Effectiveness** – 10 Marks
- **Discipline, Structure & Time Management** – 10 Marks

Total: 100 Marks

Rewards & Recognition

- **Winner:** Premium Reward Voucher or Cash
- **Runner-Up:** Voucher or Cash
- **Special Recognition:** Voucher or Cash

Why This Programme Matters

Participation in this event helps students: - Perform effectively in **group discussions and interviews** - Build the confidence to speak under evaluation - Break the fear of judgement and public scrutiny - Learn *how to think*, not *what to think* - Network with **like-minded, driven individuals** - Develop leadership qualities valued across professions

Organising Committee

NIT Jalandhar Student Initiative
Led by Anand

Contact & Coordination

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This is not merely a debate.

It is a platform to test judgement, presence, responsibility, and leadership in the information age.

Think critically. Speak responsibly. Lead consciously.

TARANG